

Introduction to FastTrack for Chrome OS

Traditional operating systems, be it Windows, Mac or Linux-based, have held us tied down to a few out-dated assumptions for computers. We've embraced them as a given and continued to adopt upgrade after upgrade without much thought. But now we've reached a point where Google, unlike legacy OS creators Microsoft and Apple, is changing the way we perceive operating systems. Now is the dawn of the cloud based operating system and Chrome OS is its most prominent emissary.

But despite Chrome OS's growing popularity across a variety of industries, it is misunderstood. Isn't Chrome OS just a browser masquerading as an operating system? Is it all hype? How can you really use it? Well, these questions are just the start of this month's issue of FastTrack.

We take a couple of chapters to quickly distinguish Chrome OS's identity and show why Google is so deeply invested in it as a product. We delve deeper into the subtleties of the cloud based systems that Chrome OS is so notorious about and explain what an "appliance computer" is meant to be. We move on from these technical and industry discussions to help you determine if Chrome OS is a viable alternative for your work and lifestyle.

We next move on to the real fun stuff with a chapter that gives a detailed review of Google's Chromebooks which are currently available in the market. We cover all the essential details of Google's product line from price to performance, and even point the way to the expected releases coming up in the near future.

The next few chapters systematically guide you towards experiencing your very own Chrome OS system. These surprisingly easy steps allow you to test drive and take on the operating system using its open source cousin